GitHub Pro: four dollars a month for a lock on the private desks

The first proposal written against the expense ledger. Small, specific, and the kind of line a sole proprietor keeps on purpose.

Proposal 001 | Status asking | Started 2026-11-04 | For Christopher

TL;DR

1. **The problem it solves.** On Nov 4, 2026 Kenney was given write access to `proposals-thef`, a private repository under Christopher's personal account. GitHub Free cannot put a rule in front of `main` on a private personal repository: the API answered "Upgrade to GitHub Pro or make this repository public to enable this feature" when the rulesets were read. The same limit will meet `ops-arb` and every other private desk shared with a partner.
2. **What Pro buys.** Repository rules and branch protection on private repositories (a pull request before anything lands on `main`, required checks such as the tripwire self-test and ggshield, required reviewers, CODEOWNERS), GitHub Pages on private repositories, and more Actions minutes. Price: **$4 a month** for an individual account, as GitHub's upgrade prompt and billing page name it; the public pricing page shows the organisation equivalent, Team, at $4 per user per month.
3. **What it does not buy.** Nothing for the organisations (THEF, PIR, ORG, Psanctuary, the Church, Taylor's, Jeff's): their private repositories would need Team, per member. The reading rooms are the right fence there, and they are free. Pro covers Christopher's own private repositories only.
4. **Until it is bought,** the watchdog on `proposals-thef` reports every push by anyone but the steward (WATCHDOG.md there). A watchdog barks; Pro is the lock.
5. **The expense line.** $48 a year, 100% business: every repository on the account is the work. It goes on the ledger the day it is bought, with the receipt's folder named.

Decision

Door	Cost	What changes
A. Buy Pro now	$4/month	turn on rules for `proposals-thef`, `ops-arb` and any desk a partner can write to: pull request required on `main`, the tripwire self-test and ggshield as required checks, one review; the watchdog stays as the record
B. Wait	$0	the watchdog is the only guard; every push is in history; fine for a drafting desk, thin for a desk holding procedures
C. Move shared desks into an organisation	$0	read-only members become possible, but a lab desk stops being a lab desk; the reading rooms already give partners the read side

Lean: **A**, when the next card cycle allows; **B** until then, with the watchdog in place.

The steps after buying

1. GitHub → Settings → Billing → Plans → Pro.
2. For each shared private desk: Settings → Rules → Rulesets → New branch ruleset: target `main`; require a pull request before merging (1 review); require status checks (the tripwire self-test, ggshield); block force pushes. The same for `preview` where a desk uses it.
3. Add a `CODEOWNERS` naming the steward for `PUBLIC-ALLOWLIST*.txt`, `.github/`, `scripts/`.
4. Add the row to EXPENSE-LEDGER.md with the receipt's folder.

Sources: GitHub's API message on `repos/drasticstatic/proposals-thef/rulesets` (2026-11-04); github.com/pricing (read 2026-11-04; Team $4 per user per month, Enterprise $21). Not tax advice: whether the line is deductible is a CPA's call; the ledger only keeps it honest.